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PHASE TRAIN TO WIN

FORMAT FREE 5-DAY PROGRAM

WEEK ONE / BODYWEIGHT ONLY

THE *First* FIVE DAYS

A 5-day off-ice training program for adult hockey players in their peak performance years. Bodyweight only. No gym required. 30–45 minutes a session. Built on the same Train-to-Win principles used by elite-level coaching programs — adapted for the player who's training around work, life, and a real schedule.

01

STRENGTH

02

SPEED

03

POWER

04

CONDITION

05

INTEGRATE

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TRAIN HARD. TRAIN *smart.*

You are in your physical prime — what sport scientists call the “Train to Win” window of long-term athletic development. Strength, power, and aerobic capacity aren’t just trainable in your twenties and thirties — they’re expected. What you put in off the ice now determines what you carry onto the ice every shift.

The problem is that most adult hockey players train like fitness enthusiasts, not athletes. Generic gym programs don’t transfer. Random “leg day” doesn’t build a stronger stride. Your sport is specific. Your training should be too.

These five days are bodyweight-only — because most adult players are training around work, family, travel, and limited time. Every session is built on three non-negotiables: hockey specificity, real intensity, movement quality.

01

SPECIFICITY

The SAID principle — your body adapts specifically to what you ask of it. Random training produces random results. Every exercise here is chosen for one reason: your next shift.

02

INTENSITY

Bodyweight doesn’t mean easy. Tempo, leverage, and unilateral work scale intensity to any level. If a rep is too easy, make it harder before you make it longer.

03

RECOVERY = ADAPTATION

Training breaks you down. Sleep, food, and managed stress build you back up. Skip recovery and you’ve trained for nothing.

“*Quality over speed. If a rep looks ugly, slow down.*”

FIVE DAYS. ONE WEEK. ONE STRONGER *player.*

Pick five days that fit your schedule — they don't need to be Monday through Friday. The recommended rhythm is two-on, one-off, two-on, one-off. Each session runs 30–45 minutes including warm-up and cool-down. You need a small open space and a floor. No equipment. If something hurts (not “burns” — actually hurts), stop. The goal is to walk into next week stronger, not into a clinic.

DAY 01

MAX STRENGTH FOUNDATION

~ 40 MIN

DAY 02

SPEED & PLYOMETRICS

~ 35 MIN

DAY 03

UPPER BODY POWER + POSTERIOR CHAIN

~ 40 MIN

DAY 04

ANAEROBIC CONDITIONING

~ 35 MIN

DAY 05

HOCKEY INTEGRATION CIRCUIT

~ 45 MIN

HOW TO READ A WORKOUT

EVERY EXERCISE CARD HAS FIVE PARTS.

The number is the order. Sets and reps tell you how many.

Tempo tells you the speed of each rep — a 3-1-1-0 tempo means 3 seconds lowering, 1 second pause, 1 second up, 0 seconds rest at the top. Rest is how long you wait before the next set.

You'll see **RPE** numbers throughout — Rate of Perceived Exertion on a 1–10 scale. RPE 8 means you have 2 reps left in the tank. RPE 9 means 1 left. RPE 10 is failure. Most quality work lives at RPE 7–8. Higher isn't always better.

The coaching cue is the one thing the coach would say standing next to you. “What it builds” is the hockey reason for the work.

01 EXERCISE NAME

REPS	4 × 8 each leg
TEMPO	4-1-1-0
REST	90s
RPE	8

How to do it — clear instructions.

Coaching cue — the one thing.

BUILDS The hockey reason.

THE *warm-up.*

Three movements. Five minutes. Every session. The warm-up is not optional — it's how you bring your nervous system online, open the joints hockey demands, and avoid the silly injuries that derail a training week. Move with control. Breathe through your nose if you can.

01

90/90 HIP SWITCH

2 ROUNDS × 6 EACH SIDE

Sit on the floor with one leg in front at 90° (shin parallel to your body) and the other leg behind at 90°. Keep both knees on the floor. Rotate the hips to switch sides. Hands light on the floor for balance.

“Drive the back knee through the floor.”

BUILDS

Hip internal and external rotation — the range you need for a clean stride and a powerful crossover.

02

WORLD'S GREATEST STRETCH

2 ROUNDS × 4 EACH SIDE

From a push-up position, step your right foot outside your right hand. Drop your right elbow toward the floor. Reach your right hand to the ceiling, opening the chest. Place the hand back down, step back, switch.

“Rotate from the mid-back, not the lower back.”

BUILDS

T-spine rotation, hip mobility, and full posterior chain prep in one movement.

03

A-SKIP

2 ROUNDS × 20M

Skip forward with exaggerated knee drive. Front knee comes up to hip height. Opposite arm pumps hard. Land softly on the ball of the foot. Tall posture throughout — this is not jogging.

“Tall and bouncy. Drive the knee — pump the arm.”

BUILDS

CNS activation and sprint-pattern priming. Wakes the nervous system before fast work.

01

MAX STRENGTH *foundation.*

Today builds the engine of your skating. Strength at this stage is about controlled, heavy-feeling work with bodyweight — using tempo, leverage, and unilateral positions to create real intensity. We're not chasing exhaustion. We're chasing quality reps that demand everything from your legs.

BEGIN WITH THE WARM-UP (PAGE 04). ALWAYS.

~ 40 MIN • BODYWEIGHT ONLY

01 BULGARIAN SPLIT SQUAT

4 × 8 EACH LEG • TEMPO 4-1-1-0 • REST 90S • RPE 8

Stand a long stride from a low surface (couch, bench, chair). Place the laces of your back foot on the surface, weight on the front leg. Drop the back knee straight down toward the floor. Front knee tracks over your second toe. Drive through the heel and mid-foot. The front leg does 90% of the work.

"Front knee tracks the toe. Back leg is just a kickstand."

BUILDS Unilateral lower-body strength — the exact pattern of a skating stride, where one leg drives while the other prepares to fire.

02 PISTOL SQUAT PROGRESSION

3 × 5 EACH LEG • TEMPO 3-2-1-0 • REST 90S • RPE 8

Stand on one leg with the other extended forward, heel hovering. Sit back and down as far as you control, hips behind the heel. Use a doorframe or TRX for hand support if needed — this is a progression, not an ego lift. Drive through the full foot to stand.

"Sit between your heels — not over them."

BUILDS Maximal single-leg strength and ankle/hip mobility under load. The most hockey-specific bodyweight strength movement there is.

03 COSSACK SQUAT

3 × 6 EACH SIDE • TEMPO 3-1-1-0 • REST 60S • RPE 7

Wide stance, toes turned slightly out. Shift your weight to one side, bending that knee deeply while the other leg stays straight, heel down. Chest tall. The straight-leg toes point up. Return through center, then shift to the other side.

"Long leg, heel down. Deep leg, heel down. No cheating."

BUILDS Lateral strength and adductor control — the muscles that win edge battles and absorb hits on the boards.

04 NORDIC HAMSTRING CURL

3 × 5 • TEMPO 5-0-X-0 • REST 90S • RPE 9

Kneel on a soft surface. Anchor your ankles (partner, loaded couch, sturdy bar). Arms crossed at chest. Hinge forward from the knees only — body in a straight line knee-to-head — lowering as slowly as you can. Catch yourself with your hands at the bottom and push back up. The eccentric is the whole point.

02

SPEED & power.

Today is short, sharp, and fully recovered. Plyometrics and sprint work are CNS-driven — they need a fresh nervous system, not a tired body. You'll do less total volume than yesterday and rest longer between sets. If you rush rest periods, you train conditioning, not speed. Discipline yourself.

BEGIN WITH THE WARM-UP (PAGE 04). DON'T SKIP.

~ 35 MIN • OPEN SPACE NEEDED

01 BROAD JUMP

5 × 3 • FULL REST (~90S) • RPE 9 EFFORT, QUALITY IS KING

Feet shoulder-width, arms swing back, jump forward as far as you can. Land in a quarter-squat, both feet together, hold for 2 seconds. Walk back to the start. No rebound reps — every jump starts from a dead stop.

"Maximum jump. Frozen landing."

BUILDS Lower-body concentric power and the eccentric landing strength that protects your knees and hips through hockey's deceleration demands.

02 LATERAL BOUND

4 × 4 EACH SIDE • REST 60S • RPE 8

Stand on the right leg. Push laterally off the right and land on the left in a soft athletic position. Pause one full second to confirm balance. Push back to the right. Two reps total.

"Stick the landing for one full second. Then go."

BUILDS Lateral power production and single-leg deceleration — the exact pattern of every push and stop on the ice.

03 DEPTH DROP TO STICK

3 × 5 • REST 60S • RPE 7

Stand on a low surface (step, thick book, low couch — knee-height max). Step off (don't jump) and land in a quarter-squat, freezing on impact. Hold 3 seconds. The drop teaches your tendons and connective tissue to absorb force — the foundation for higher-level reactive work.

"Land soft. Stop dead. Eyes forward."

BUILDS Reactive strength and tendon stiffness — the elastic quality that converts ground contact into propulsion.

04 30-METER ACCELERATION SPRINT

6 REPS • FULL REST (~90S) • RPE 9-10

Start from a 2-point staggered stance, body angled forward. Drive out hard, accelerating over 30 meters. The first 10 meters are pure piston action — knee drive, low body angle. Walk back. Reset. Repeat.

"First three steps are the workout. Make them perfect."

BUILDS First-step acceleration — the most hockey-specific speed quality. Most loose pucks are won in the first three strides.

03

UPPER & posterior.

Hockey is a posterior-chain sport. Your back, glutes, and hamstrings drive every stride, every shot, every battle. Today builds those — alongside upper-body pushing and pulling strength that holds up under physical play. Anti-rotation core finishes the session, because spine stability is what keeps the rest of this work translating to the ice.

BEGIN WITH THE WARM-UP (PAGE 04).

~ 40 MIN • BODYWEIGHT ONLY

01 ARCHER PUSH-UP

4 × 5 EACH SIDE • TEMPO 3-1-1-0 • REST 75S • RPE 8

Wide push-up position, arms about 1.5× shoulder width apart. Lower toward one hand while the other arm stays straight (it's a brace). The working side does most of the work. Drive back up. Alternate sides. Knees down is a fine regression.

"Sink to one side. Brace with the other."

BUILDS Unilateral pushing strength — closer to a one-arm push-up than a regular one. Builds the upper body that holds its ground in puck battles.

02 SINGLE-LEG RDL

4 × 8 EACH LEG • TEMPO 3-1-1-0 • REST 75S • RPE 8

Stand on one leg, slight bend in the knee. Hinge at the hip — chest goes forward, free leg goes back, body forms a T parallel to the floor. Reach the opposite hand toward the standing foot. Return to standing under control. Balance is part of the exercise.

"Hips square. Long line — head to back heel."

BUILDS Hamstring and glute strength under length — the exact loading pattern your stride needs to extend powerfully.

03 PULL-UP OR INVERTED ROW

4 × 6-8 • TEMPO 2-1-2-0 • REST 90S • RPE 8

Pull-up: hands shoulder-width, full hang, pull until chin clears the bar, lower under control over 2 seconds. No bar? Inverted row off a sturdy table edge or under a desk — heels on the floor, body straight, pull chest to the surface.

"Lead with the chest. Squeeze the shoulder blades."

BUILDS Vertical and horizontal pulling strength. Counter-balances the pushing demands of the sport and protects shoulder health.

04 SINGLE-LEG ELEVATED HIP THRUST

3 × 10 EACH LEG • 2S PAUSE AT TOP • REST 60S • RPE 8

Shoulders on a couch or low bench, knees bent, one foot flat on the floor. The other leg extends straight out. Drive through the planted heel and lift the hips until they form a straight line knees-to-shoulders. Squeeze the glute hard at the top for 2 seconds. Lower slowly.

"Squeeze the glute. Don't arch the lower back."

BUILDS Glute power on a single leg — the actual driver of the skating stride. Most adult players have weak, sleepy glutes. Today they wake up.

04

CONDITION

like you play.

A hockey shift is roughly 45 seconds of all-out work followed by 2–4 minutes of rest. That ratio — about 1:3 to 1:5 — is what your conditioning should mirror. Steady-state jogging doesn't train this. Long intervals don't train this. What trains it is repeated short maximal efforts with full recovery. This work sits on Day 4 deliberately, after Day 3's lift, to avoid concurrent training interference.

BEGIN WITH THE WARM-UP (PAGE 04).

~ 35 MIN • OPEN SPACE OR STAIRS

01 SHIFT SHUTTLE INTERVALS

8 ROUNDS • WORK 30S : REST 60S • RPE 9

30 seconds of maximum-effort shuttle running between two markers 15m apart. 60 seconds of complete rest — walk, breathe, drink. The hockey work-to-rest ratio. The first round will feel easy. The last round will not.

"Round 8 looks like round 1. That's the standard."

BUILDS Anaerobic capacity at hockey's exact work-to-rest ratio. Trains your body to recover between shifts and come back fresh.

02 BURPEE-TO-BOUND COMPLEX

5 ROUNDS • WORK 20S : REST 40S • RPE 9

20 seconds continuous: burpee → broad jump → drop and burpee → broad jump. 40 seconds of full rest. Five rounds total. The complex puts you horizontal and vertical, fast and powerful — like the unpredictability of a real shift.

"Every burpee is a deliberate position, not a flop."

BUILDS Mixed-modal anaerobic power. Trains the heart, lungs, and legs to handle hockey's chaos.

03 BEAR-CRAWL FOR DISTANCE

4 ROUNDS × 20M • REST 60S • RPE 8

On hands and feet, knees an inch off the floor. Drive forward 20 meters as fast as you can while holding the position. Walk back. Repeat. This is the closest bodyweight substitute for a heavy sled push.

"Hips low. Drive the floor backward."

BUILDS Full-body horizontal power production. Mimics the body angle of a hard acceleration.

04 BREATH RESET

2 MINUTES • ACTIVE RECOVERY

After the last interval, walk slowly. Hands on head — opens the chest. Nasal inhale 4 seconds, mouth exhale 6 seconds. Continuous for 2 minutes. This is the active recovery your nervous system needs to switch out of fight-or-flight.

"Slow your breath. Slow your heart."

05

HOCKEY

integration.

The last day pulls everything together. Strength, speed, and conditioning in one circuit at game-pace. This is what the program has been building toward — a session that feels like a high-pressure shift. Pace yourself. Form first. The goal isn't to survive the circuit. It's to attack each round at the level you'd attack each shift.

BEGIN WITH THE WARM-UP (PAGE 04). DO IT TWICE TODAY.

~ 45 MIN • 4 ROUNDS • REST 2 MIN BETWEEN ROUNDS

PROTOCOL

4 rounds. Move station to station with minimal rest within a round. 2 minutes rest between rounds. Each round is one "shift" — finish the work in roughly 60–75 seconds. That's the upper end of a long shift.

A1 SPLIT-SQUAT JUMP

4 ROUNDS × 6 EACH LEG • RPE 8

Bulgarian split-squat position. Jump up explosively, switch legs in the air, land in the opposite split. The eccentric landing matters as much as the jump.

"Hip drives the jump. Soft on the landing."

A2 LATERAL BOUND

4 ROUNDS × 4 EACH SIDE • RPE 7

From single-leg, bound sideways and stick the landing for one full second before pushing back.

"Stick it. Then go."

A3 PUSH-UP TO SHOULDER TAP

4 ROUNDS × 8 EACH SIDE • RPE 7

Push-up plank. After each push-up, tap the opposite shoulder with one hand without letting the hips rotate.

"Stay square. Hips don't move."

A4 SPRINT

4 ROUNDS × 20M • RPE 9

Maximum effort 20-meter sprint between two markers. Walk back. The sprint is your shift.

"This is your shift. Make it count."

THREE PROTOCOLS. FIFTEEN *minutes.*

Drop-in conditioning sessions for a rest day, a travel day, or any time you have 15 minutes and a heartbeat. All built on the same hockey work-to-rest principle. Pick one. Time it. Beat it next time. Or stack them across a week if you're building extra capacity ahead of the season.

01

TABATA PROTOCOL

NEED: TIMER • 4 MIN TOTAL

20 seconds work, 10 seconds rest, 8 rounds. Pick one movement — burpees, sprint-in-place, mountain climbers, jump squats — and go all-out for each 20-second window. Don't pace it. Don't be smart. Maximum effort, every window.

Anaerobic power, lactate tolerance, mental edge.

02

SHIFT REPLICATOR

NEED: OPEN SPACE • 14 MIN TOTAL

5 rounds, each one a shift. Each round: 45 seconds maximum-effort shuttle running, then 2 minutes complete rest (walk, breathe). Five "shifts" in 14 minutes. The closest off-ice replica of an actual period of play.

Game-specific conditioning, recovery between shifts.

03

STAIR INTERVAL

NEED: A FLIGHT OF STAIRS • 15 MIN TOTAL

10 rounds: sprint up one flight, walk down. Aim for 8–12 seconds up. The walk down is your full rest. Stop when your sprint-up time slows by more than 2 seconds — that's power dropping, and you're now training the wrong system.

Lower-body power-endurance, perfect for travel days.

04

ZONE 2 WALK

NEED: NOTHING • 45-60 MIN

A brisk, conversational-pace walk — fast enough that you can speak in sentences but not paragraphs. Zone 2 trains mitochondrial function and the aerobic base that powers recovery between high-intensity bouts. The unglamorous work that makes the glamorous work possible.

Aerobic base, recovery, mitochondrial density.

A note on intervals: every protocol here is short, intense, and recovery-respecting. Long, moderate cardio — the default of most adult athletes — builds aerobic base, which has value. But it isn't what makes you better at hockey. Use Zone 2 for the base. Use the others for the sport.

RECOVERY IS WHEN YOU GET *better*.

Training is the stimulus. Recovery is the adaptation. Skip this page and you've trained for nothing. Four levers move the needle more than any single workout you do — and the truth is most adult athletes get these wrong.

SLEEP

7–9

HOURS PER NIGHT

The most underrated performance enhancer available. Deep sleep is when growth hormone releases, when the central nervous system clears training fatigue, when motor patterns consolidate. One short night is recoverable. A pattern of short sleep is not. Phones out of the bedroom. Same window every night. Cooler room beats warm.

FUEL

1.6–2.2

G PROTEIN / KG BODYWEIGHT / DAY

Build every meal around protein first: meat, fish, eggs, dairy, legumes. Then add a quality carb (rice, potato, oats, fruit) and a vegetable. Eat within an hour after training when you can. We don't count calories. We eat real food, often, with protein at the center.

HYDRATION + ALCOHOL

3–4L

WATER PER DAY

Hydrate consistently across the day — not chugged at training. A liter in the morning is more valuable than a liter at the rink. Alcohol is a hard truth for adult players: it disrupts sleep architecture, depresses protein synthesis for up to 24 hours, and elevates resting heart rate. You don't have to be a monk. Just understand the cost.

STRESS

=

TRAINING LOAD

Your nervous system doesn't separate work stress from training stress. A hard week at the office is fatigue your body has to recover from too. On those weeks, pull back training volume, prioritize sleep, and accept that adaptation comes from total load — not from the gym alone.

THIS IS THE *foundation.*

You've just done five days of real off-ice work. If it felt hard but doable, you're exactly where most committed adult players land. Two things are coming — be the first to know when they launch.

THE 12-WEEK PROGRAM

POWER & SPEED FOR HOCKEY

LAUNCHING SOON

- 12 weeks of progressive programming
- Three phases — strength, power, integration
- Full video library for every movement
- Testing protocol with hockey benchmarks
- Conditioning blocks built on shift ratios
- Direct line for programming questions

The program these five days were built to introduce you to. Same framework I use with the players I coach in person — scaled for adult hockey players training around real life.

COMING SOON

ELITE HOCKEY DRILLS APP

LAUNCHING THIS YEAR

A full off-ice training app built specifically for hockey players. Drills, programs, tracking, and a video-coached library — designed by a coach who's worked from grassroots through national team level.

Built for the player who trains around work, life, and a real schedule.

STAY *tuned.*

Follow on Instagram and check the website for launch dates, founding-member access, and early-bird pricing when both go live.



EDU M.ED. SPORT SCIENCE

EXP 10+ YEARS COACHING

ROLES HOCKEY PERFORMANCE COACH

TEACHES PE & SPORT SCIENCE

BRAND FOUNDER, ELITE HOCKEY DRILLS

FROM THE COACH

COACH DAVID CIBOCH

M.ED. SPORT SCIENCE / STRENGTH & CONDITIONING / HOCKEY

I'm a sport science coach who has spent the last decade working with hockey players — from first-time skaters to international competition. I also work full-time as a Physical Education and Sport Science teacher, and off-ice training is where I've spent most of my career.

I built Elite Hockey Drills because the off-ice world is dominated by generic, copy-paste programming that doesn't respect the sport or the player. Hockey is specific. Training should be specific too. The 12-Week Power & Speed program and the app — both launching soon — are my answer to that problem.

What you just did over five days is real work. If you're still committed to playing your best hockey as an adult, this is just the start. Train with intent. Move well. The years take what you give them.

— *Coach David*

“The adult player who trains with intent doesn't get worse with age. He gets better at where it matters.”

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